Course Syllabus

WELCOME TO CARTOGRAPHY!

A printable version of the syllabus, with more detailed information on expectations and policies, is available here (https://canvas.humboldt.edu/courses/78882/pages/gsp-316-unabridged-syllabus) .

YOUR INSTRUCTOR

Amy E. Rock, Ph.D.
Department of Geography
Humboldt State University

- **Email**: Amy.Rock@humboldt.edu (mailto:Amy.Rock@humboldt.edu) . Always use your Humboldt email account to contact me, as outside accounts matching Humboldt student names are often flagged as spam or phishing, and may not reach me.
- **Office Hours**: This course is conducted entirely online. Office hours will be replaced with email, the **Slack** (http://hsucartography.slack.com) workspace, or Zoom sessions by appointment. General questions about the course format and content should be posted to Slack. Personal matters should be restricted to direct email or DMs on Slack, and should not be posted in the general channels.

Course communications

This syllabus and other course materials will be posted to the course website (this Canvas course). All assignments will be provided and submitted there as well. Any changes to the schedule will also be posted in the Announcements section. Check your **Canvas Notifications** (https://canvas.humboldt.edu/profile/communication) to ensure you are receiving email notification of new announcements, and make sure you are checking your Humboldt email, as messages will be sent there.

If you have a question about an assignment or course concept, you should post it to the **appropriate Slack channel** (http://hsucartography.slack.com) . This is visible to all course participants, and your peers may be able to answer your questions more promptly, particularly during evenings and weekends. Responses will also be visible to the group, so questions need only be answered once. Be sure to skim through previous posts before adding a new question (or use the Search tool), to see if it's already been answered. Please do not wait until the end of the course if you are struggling with concepts or skills. This information is cumulative, and your future success depends on your current comprehension. If you

have a question about grades or a personal matter, do not post it to the forum - email me directly, or make a Virtual Office Hours appointment.

NOTE: I will read and respond to e-mail and Slack (http://hsucartography.slack.com) posts at least once per day, Monday through Friday.

ABOUT THE COURSE

This course will explore the art and science of cartography, using tools available in ArcGIS Pro. Computers make creating maps easier, but sound cartographic principles must still be applied to achieve meaningful results. Students will develop the skills necessary to develop professional-looking maps for publication or research and learn various techniques to create the best map for the task at hand.

Prerequisites: You must successfully complete GSP 101: Geospatial Concepts to take this course.

Course Objectives

During this course, students will:

- Understand the basic principles of visual representation of data and apply cartographic theory to communicate the data effectively.
- Gain competency in the cartographic tools of ArcGIS and the design process for computer generated maps.
- Apply critical thinking and communication skills to prepare visualizations which meet a variety of needs, and reflect sound cartographic ethics.
- Interpret, evaluate and constructively critique maps with the goal of increasing competency, understanding and appreciation of map design.
- Acquire competency with major geospatial data sources, and be able to acquire and prepare data to communicate visually with a range of audiences.

Required Readings

- Principles of Map Design, by Judith A. Tyner
- Additional readings will be posted to the course website

PARTICIPATION & ACCESS

This course is presented in Canvas, and can be accessed directly via http://canvas.humboldt.edu and signing in with your Cal Poly Humboldt login and password. As this is a web-based class, it is your responsibility to access the course via a suitable computer and internet connection. The instructor and university assume no responsibility for computer crashes or failure on your part to complete any aspect of the course as scheduled. You may work ahead through the chapters and assignments, but be aware of assignment and examination close dates, and plan accordingly. If you require assistance accessing the course, please contact the Help Desk at help@humboldt.edu or (707) 826-HELP (4357).

This class is a combination of assigned readings and online presentations. Not all details will be covered by the presentations; therefore it is essential that you complete the assigned readings. Likewise, not all material covered in the presentations will be in your textbooks. Your attention to detail will directly affect your grade, as will your participation in group discussions and critiques.

The discussions are intended to facilitate your understanding of the material. Because this is an online course, interaction with classmates you may never see requires more effort on your part. To receive full credit for discussions, you must participate in a meaningful way to the group postings. Profanity or otherwise offensive postings will not be tolerated, and may result in an F for the course.

Discussions will be monitored by the instructor, but do not anticipate a response to every posting. You and your classmates should work to help each other understand the material. The instructor may make comments to clarify or redirect the discussion as needed. If you have questions or concerns to address specifically to your instructor, please contact me via e-mail.

TECHNICAL REQUIREMENTS

Your computer must be able to meet the course requirements. To view and test these requirements, go to the **Orientation module (https://canvas.humboldt.edu/courses/78882/pages/module-0-orientation)** .

Computers on Campus

If you are near the Humboldt campus, you are also are welcome to use any of the geospatial computer labs on campus during open lab hours. These labs include Forestry 203 and 204A, and Natural Resources 203. There are also computers on the first floor of the Cal Poly Humboldt library with geospatial software installed, though performance may be an issue. Students may inquire at the Humboldt Library Help Desk for details on the current status of computers and software.

Courses are also taught in these computer labs, so **please be respectful.** Check the schedule posted on the door before entering. **Do not** interrupt an ongoing class. If you arrive at the start of a class, always ask the instructor permission to use the computers if there is a class in session.

Check the schedule posted outside the rooms below to find out when there are open lab hours.

Building	Room	Door Code
Natural Resources	203	1913
Forestry	203	7894
Forestry	204	4278
Science A	364	N/A
Cal Poly Humboldt Library	1st Floor	N/A

COURSE FORMAT

This course is organized into a series of modules, designed to be completed weekly. Course modules group together a series of related chapters, activities, assignments, and quizzes. Each module may be accessed from the course home page.

Weekly assignments are due on Sunday each week. Initial discussion posts should ideally be posted by Friday, to give your classmates time for discussion responses due on Sunday. Late work will not be penalized (see below), but be aware that your classmates need to critique your submission in a timely fashion, and be courteous. Activities must be submitted in order to open the next module, and all work must be completed by the close of the course.

Examinations and assignments are listed in the course outline below, and are **subject to change**. You are responsible for knowing when your work is due – any changes to due dates will be posted on the Canvas calendar and in Announcements. Please see your Canvas calendar and/or the Syllabus link for the most current version.

Module Prerequisites

You must progress through the modules sequentially. You must also complete earlier modules before you can progress to the next in the module in the series. Requirements for completion might include viewing the previous page, completing a previous assignment, or completing a previous quiz or exam.

> **Note:** Submitting fake/placeholder assignments is **not allowed**. A student who submits fake work to unlock modules will receive a zero for that assignment and re-submissions will not be accepted. Multiple instances of submitting fake assignments will be considered a form of academic dishonesty and a **violation of the course academic integrity policy,** resulting in a failing grade for the course.

Late Policies and Soft Deadlines

GSP 316 is an **asynchronous** course. There are no required meeting times. Students are free to work at times that best fit their needs. Deadlines are presented as guidelines to keep you on track, and for most assignments, there are no late penalties. No submissions will be accepted after the close of the course.

There are some exceptions to this rule:

- Discussion Forums: Only earn extra credit points for posts that are submitted ***before*** the due date. Fewer points are awarded as time goes on (see rubrics for details).
- Exams will only be available during the period specified.
- No work can be submitted the course ends

If you will be conducting field research or other work that may limit internet access during exam periods, or at the close of the course, consult with me about possible alternate arrangements for the affected week(s). Except in an emergency, notifications must be at least 48 hours in advance of the deadline.

EVALUATION & GRADING

Your grade will be composed of map activities (30%), discussions (25%), a final exam (10%), a final project (25%) and participation in peer critique (10%) The exam will only be available during a specific window, and must be completed during that time, unless we have made prior arrangements. All grades will be posted in Canvas, and feedback provided by way of rubrics and comments. Please view the feedback on each assignment, as it is designed to help you improve your work on the next item.

While the participation component is not large, it can bring a borderline grade to the positive side. Participation does not mean posting a couple of words in every peer review, but rather thoughtful and measured contribution to critiques.

All grades will be posted in Canvas. You may check your grade at any time **here (https://canvas.humboldt.edu/courses/78882/grades)** .

Grading Scale

A/A- 90-100% **B+/B/B-** 80-89% **C+/C/C-** 70-79% **D+/D** 60-69% **F** <60%

A minimum grade of C- is required for this course to count as a prerequisite for other geospatial courses or toward a certificate or minor.

UNIVERSITY POLICIES & RESOURCES

Academic honesty: Students are responsible for knowing policy regarding academic honesty. For more information, visit: **Academic Honesty Policy (https://studentrights.humboldt.edu/academic-honesty)**

Students with Disabilities: Persons who wish to request disability-related accommodations should contact the Student Disability Resource Center in House 71, 826-4678 (voice) or 826-5392 (TDD). Some accommodations may take up to several weeks to arrange. **Student Disability Resource Center (https://disability.humboldt.edu/)**

Service Animals: Service animals are welcome in the classroom and lab spaces. Pets and emotional support or therapy animals are not, no matter how adorable and well-behaved. **Cal Poly Humboldt Service Animal Policy (https://policy.humboldt.edu/emp11-05-humboldt-state-university-service-dog-policy)**

Add/Drop policy: Students are responsible for knowing the University policy, procedures, and schedule for dropping or adding classes. **Schedule Adjustments (Adding or Dropping) (https://registrar.humboldt.edu/registration/help)**

Additional Student Support: A complete list of services available to support your academic success and wellbeing are available here: **https://academicprograms.humboldt.edu/content/syllabus-addendum (https://academicprograms.humboldt.edu/content/syllabus-addendum)**

COURSE SCHEDULE

See below (https://humboldt.instructure.com/courses/1793194/assignments/syllabus) for a complete listing of assignment due dates, or follow the Calendar at left. All assignments are to be submitted online.

Weekly Format: Begins Monday at 12:05 AM and ends Sunday at 11:55 PM (except as noted)

Start Date: 3/18/2024 **End Date:** 5/10/2024

> **This 8-week course ends Friday, May 10, 2024 at 11:59PM.**
> All coursework must be submitted before this date and time.
> This Canvas course **will not be available** after the course is complete. Be sure to download any personal information before this time. Official grades will be posted by the Office of the Registrar.

Course Summary:

Date	Details	Due
Tue Jan 21, 2025	Module 1: Communicating with Maps	to do: 11:59pm
Wed Jan 22, 2025	Lecture: History of Cartography	to do: 11:59pm
Thu Jan 23, 2025	Lecture: The Critique Process	to do: 11:59pm
Fri Jan 24, 2025	Lecture: The Language of Maps	to do: 11:59pm
Sun Jan 26, 2025	Activity 1: My Favorite Map (https://canvas.humboldt.edu/courses/78882/assignments/659598)	due by 11:59pm
	Activity 2: Mental Map (https://canvas.humboldt.edu/courses/78882/assignments/659614)	due by 11:59pm
	Activity: eLearning 101, Orientation To Online Learning (https://canvas.humboldt.edu/courses/78882/assignments/659621)	due by 11:59pm
	Discussion: Dangerous maps (https://canvas.humboldt.edu/courses/78882/assignments/659599)	due by 11:59pm

Date	Details	Due
Mon Jan 27, 2025	Module 2: Map Design	to do: 11:59pm
Tue Jan 28, 2025	Lecture: Map Design Basics	to do: 11:59pm
Wed Jan 29, 2025	Lecture: Good Design	to do: 11:59pm
Thu Jan 30, 2025	Lecture: Coordinates & Projections	to do: 11:59pm
Sun Feb 2, 2025	Activity 3: Compilation Sheet (https://canvas.humboldt.edu/courses/78882/assignments/659615)	due by 11:59pm
	Activity 4: Projections (https://canvas.humboldt.edu/courses/78882/assignments/659616)	due by 11:59pm
	Discussion: Map goals (https://canvas.humboldt.edu/courses/78882/assignments/659600)	due by 11:59pm
Mon Feb 3, 2025	Module 3: Typography	to do: 11:59pm
Tue Feb 4, 2025	Lecture: Positioning Text on Maps	to do: 11:59pm
Wed Feb 5, 2025	Lecture: Typography	to do: 11:59pm
Sun Feb 9, 2025	Activity 5a: Automated Labeling (https://canvas.humboldt.edu/courses/78882/assignments/659617)	due by 11:59pm
	Activity 5b: Manual Labeling (https://canvas.humboldt.edu/courses/78882/assignments/659618)	due by 11:59pm
	Discussion: Typographic errors (https://canvas.humboldt.edu/courses/78882/assignments/659605)	due by 11:59pm
Mon Feb 10, 2025	Module 4: Cartographic Abstraction	to do: 11:59pm

Date	Details	Due
Tue Feb 11, 2025	Lecture: Abstraction & Generalization	to do: 11:59pm
Wed Feb 12, 2025	Lecture: Symbolization	to do: 11:59pm
Sun Feb 16, 2025	Activity 6a: Scale/Generalization (https://canvas.humboldt.edu/courses/78882/assignments/659619)	due by 11:59pm
	Activity 6b: Symbols (https://canvas.humboldt.edu/courses/78882/assignments/659620)	due by 11:59pm
	Discussion: Map scale (https://canvas.humboldt.edu/courses/78882/assignments/659601)	due by 11:59pm
Mon Feb 17, 2025	Module 5: Color and Mood	to do: 11:59pm
Tue Feb 18, 2025	Lecture: Color Theory and Visual Variables	to do: 11:59pm
Wed Feb 19, 2025	Lecture: Mapping for an Audience	to do: 11:59pm
Sun Feb 23, 2025	Activity 07: Final Project Proposal (https://canvas.humboldt.edu/courses/78882/assignments/659606)	due by 11:59pm
	Activity 08: Color and Mood (https://canvas.humboldt.edu/courses/78882/assignments/659607)	due by 11:59pm
	Discussion: Map audience (https://canvas.humboldt.edu/courses/78882/assignments/659603)	due by 11:59pm
Mon Feb 24, 2025	Module 6: Working with Data	to do: 11:59pm
Tue Feb 25, 2025	Lecture: Working with External Data	to do: 11:59pm
Wed Feb 26, 2025	Lecture: From Data to Maps	to do: 11:59pm

Date	Details	Due
Sun Mar 2, 2025	Activity 09: Finding Census Data (https://canvas.humboldt.edu/courses/78882/assignments/659608)	due by 11:59pm
	Activity 10: Choroplethora (https://canvas.humboldt.edu/courses/78882/assignments/659609)	due by 11:59pm
	Discussion: Finding data (https://canvas.humboldt.edu/courses/78882/assignments/659602)	due by 11:59pm
Mon Mar 3, 2025	Module 7: Maps People Love	to do: 11:59pm
Tue Mar 4, 2025	Lecture: Terrain	to do: 11:59pm
Sun Mar 9, 2025	Activity 11x: Firefly map (Extra Credit) (https://canvas.humboldt.edu/courses/78882/assignments/659610)	due by 11:59pm
	Activity 12: Madagascar (https://canvas.humboldt.edu/courses/78882/assignments/659611)	due by 11:59pm
	Discussion: Cartographic impact (https://canvas.humboldt.edu/courses/78882/assignments/659604)	due by 11:59pm
Mon Mar 10, 2025	Module 8: Wrapping Up	to do: 11:59pm
Fri Mar 14, 2025	Activity 13 Final Exam (https://canvas.humboldt.edu/courses/78882/assignments/659596)	due by 11:59pm
	Activity 14: Final Project (https://canvas.humboldt.edu/courses/78882/assignments/659613)	due by 11:59pm
	Activity 14: Final Project Submission	to do: 11:59pm
	Activity 13 Final Exam (https://canvas.humboldt.edu/courses/78882/assignments/659612)	due by 11:59pm